



2.01 Backing Up

1. Purpose

The purpose of the Standard Operating Procedure is to identify the Hazards and define the steps involved in Backing up with and without a trailer as well as with or without a Spotter .

2. Scope

This procedure is intended for use for all Silverpoint employees .

3. Hazard Assessment & Identification

- Slips , Trips , Falls
- Physical Stress
- Mental Stress
- Physical Injury
- Ergonomics
- Temperature Extremes
- Equipment Failure
- Personal Injury
- Electrical Shock
- Limited Visibility
- Excessive Noise
- Release to the Environment
- Fatigue

4. EHS Requirements

- Fire Retardant Coveralls
- CSA Approved Boots
- Safety Glasses
- Gloves
- Hardhat
- Hearing Protection

5. References

- Silverpoint Corporate Codes of Practice
- Alberta OH&S
- Silverpoint THA 1.36
- * ENFORM IRP 12
- * Silverpoint Task List



**** Backing up should be avoided at all costs due to the high risk of the maneuver and should only be performed when there is no other option . Extreme caution and a Spotter / Guide must be used if available ****

6. Procedure

- 6.1. Assess the situation to see if there is any way to modify your task at hand to eliminate the need to back up.
- 6.2. In the event that it is necessary to back up, it is most desired to have a Spotter /Guide who is responsible enough to aid you in your task.
- 6.3. Drive into position and safely park the truck.
- 6.4. Ensure your equipment is in working order. I.e., clean your windows and mirrors so that you have a clear unobstructed line of sight behind you.
- 6.5. Assess the situation .
 - 6.5.1. Using a Three-Point Contact , safely exit the cab .
 - 6.5.2. Complete a walk-around clearing your intended path of debris and obstacles .
 - 6.5.3. Take note of terrain i.e., Holes , uneven ground , buried pipes or cables , overhead power lines or personnel not aware of what you are doing .
 - 6.5.4. If it is dark, ensure that your lights are clean and in working condition .
- 6.6. Assign a spotter / guide (refer to ENFORM IRP 12).
 - 6.6.1. Discuss with your Spotter /Guide of your plan and intended path .
 - 6.6.2. Ensure that there is an understanding of pre-determined hand signals and that they understand that if they can't see you, you can't see.
 - 6.6.3. Have your spotter guide you from the back of the truck on the left side, and if access is very limited , it would be beneficial to have a spotter /guide at the front of the truck also, communicating with the spotter at the back via predetermined hand signals .
 - 6.6.4 If you lose communication / sight of your spotter (s), **STOP** immediately and do not proceed until communication / sight has been re-established . (Refer to SOP 2.01-01 ENFORM IRP 12 item # 12.2.2)
 - 6.6.5. Only back up as far as is necessary to safely do the task.
- 6.7. Safely enter your cab using three-point contact and begin the backing up procedure when it is determined that it is safe to do so.
 - 6.7.1. Turn on the 4-way flashers and sound your horn to announce that you are preparing to back up.

BACKING UP WITHOUT A TRAILER

- 6.8 Disengage the park brake and select the reverse gear. (You should hear the reverse beeper sound).
- 6.9. Begin to slowly back up, scanning all around the truck and using the mirrors to see the spotter /guide behind the truck.



6.9.1. Always back up in a straight line, if at all possible .

6.10. If you must maneuver , turn the steering wheel in the direction that you want the back of the truck to travel. Example : the spotter /guide is directing you to the left, then turn the steering wheel to the left.

6.11. You must continually scan all around the truck at all times, keeping in contact with the spotter /guide .

6.12. Once you have reached your destination and the spotter /guide has directed you, stop the truck, put the truck in neutral and engage the park brake .

6.12.1. Using the three-point contact , safely exit the cab and chock the tires . Complete a walk-around to ensure that everything is safe and free of damage .

BACKING UP WITH A TRAILER

6.13. In the event that you are backing up with a trailer in tow, follow the previous SOP with the following additions .

6.13.1. When you drive into position to safely park the truck and trailer, ensure that the truck and trailer are as straight as possible so that you can back up with the least amount of maneuvering and have a clear unobstructed view to the back of the trailer and your spotter /guide .

6.13.2. While you are out completing your walk-around , also ensure that your trailer is secure i.e., hitch is locked , safety chains are connected , air lines are hooked up, hitch pins and are in place, trailer jack is up, and trailer lights work .

6.13.3. Disengage trailer park brake and the truck park brake, then select the reverse gear and slowly begin to back up. **If you lose sight/contact with the Spotter /Guide "STOP IMMEDIATELY"**. Do not resume until contact has been reestablished with the spotter /guide . (Refer to SOP 2.01-01 ENFORM IRP 12 item # 12.2.2)

6.13.4 Always back up in a straight line if at all possible . In the event that you must maneuver with a trailer in tow; turn the steering wheel in the opposite direction that you want the back of the trailer to travel. Example , if the spotter /guide directs you to the left; turn the steering wheel to the right, making small corrections . Never chase the trailer; you can also drive forward to straighten out as many times as you feel necessary .

BACKING UP WITHOUT A SPOTTER /GUIDE

THIS MANEUVER SHOULD NOT BE USED UNLESS THERE IS NO OTHER OPTIONS . ALWAYS WALK AROUND THE UNIT TO CHECK FOR HAZARDS BEFORE BACKING UP WITHOUT A SPOTTER /GUIDE .

6.14. Should the need arise that you must back up without a spotter / guide , Example ; there is no Spotter /Guide available , or you are alone **STOP**. Assess the situation . Once you have determined that this maneuver must be performed without a spotter / guide and that there is no other alternative , be prepared to stop the truck frequently .

6.14.1. Begin to slowly safely back up and stop approx . every 10 feet of travel to ensure that you are in fact performing the task safely and that your intended path is still safe and clear .



7. Definitions

7.1. Jackknifing . The accidental folding of an articulated vehicle (such as one towing a trailer) such that it resembles the acute angle of a folding pocketknife . If a vehicle towing a trailer skids, the trailer can push it from behind until it spins round and faces backwards . This may be caused by equipment failure , improper braking , or adverse road conditions such as an icy road surface .

7.2. The Hole . The spot that you are going to be backing into .

8. Backing Accidents : although you can not control other people's actions , you can focus and concentrate on the backing effort , and this will help you to recognize a problem as quickly as it develops . The tips in this section will not prevent backing accidents , but they will help you to reduce the possibility of backing accidents .

8.1. Which parts of the unit are typically involved in backing accidents ?

8.1.1 Right side - This is pretty obvious because many backing situations position the tractor so that you cannot see the right side of the trailer. Most drivers will get out of the cab to check on the left side (driver's side) of the unit, but will not go that extra distance to get out and go around to the right (passenger's) side of the unit to check.

8.1.2. At the top - A surprising number of backing accidents involve the top of the trailer striking an overhang or getting tangled up with wires or building eaves. It is a common mistake to look around at eye level when surveying a backing location. Remember to take a look up as high as the trailer top before deciding the chance for success.

8.1.3. At the rear - Sometimes you can misjudge the distance and back into something sooner than you expect. You can also be duped if something behind you moves while you are backing. You can prevent both situations by getting out of the cab to check and recheck if conditions are tight.

8.2. Backing Accident Prevention Tips

8.2.1. Eliminate as many distractions as you can. Turn off the radio and CB and get totally focused with the backing maneuver .

8.2.2. Always check the area you are backing into before you begin backing .

8.2.3. Use your mirrors properly . You may have to adjust them for this backing situation . Take a moment and adjust as required .

8.2.4. Keep your body inside while the unit is in motion . It is tempting to hang out the door to get a better look, but this loosens the right mirror because the angle changes , and places yourself in physical danger if you get crushed by something you didn't see. It is also very hard to step on the brake quickly while you are hanging out the door.

8.2.5. Keep your right foot off the throttle ; instead keep it over the brake pedal . Loaded units usually don't need throttle to back , therefore , that right foot can remain poised to step on the brakes quickly if you see a problem developing in the mirrors .

8.2.6. When backing across city and suburban streets , many motorists don't understand or recognize what is



happening until they get right up on you. Most motorists are slow to recognize an uncommon situation. Some will also try to dart around you when there clearly isn't safe room to pass. Any method you can use to draw attention to you backing across the street will help.

8.3. Steering in Reverse

8.3.1. Jacking the Tractor - Turning the tractor so it is out of line with the trailer, causes the trailer to begin its turn. To start jacking the tractor, turn the top of the steering wheel in the direction opposite of the direction that you want the trailer to go.

8.3.2. Chase the Trailer - After the tractor is jacked, keep the tractor/trailer angle for the desired rate of turn by chasing the trailer to keep the trailer rate of turn as desired.

8.3.3. Straightening - Once the trailer turning is no longer required, you straighten the tractor, so it lines up with the trailer. Then you chase the trailer straight back.

8.4. Prepositioning and Backing

8.4.1. Straight Back Preposition - This is the easiest and safest way to back your unit. Always choose this option when it is available. It provides clear view in both mirrors. As you slowly pass the hole, steer hard at right angle to the hole which will take your truck away from the hole until your rig straightens out in front of the hole. Now back up straight and into the hole. As you approach the hole, you should get out and make sure that you are lined up properly.

8.4.2. Clear-side Preposition - Clear side refers to situations where you maintain a clear view in your left mirror while backing. This is your most common backing situation and is second choice to straight backing. Drive past the hole and allow clearance on the right side of the rig for the trailer to jack out. Now back up, jacking the tractor by turning the top of the wheel right and then chase the trailer into the hole.

8.4.3. Blind-side Preposition - Blind side refers to situations where you can only maintain a limited view in your right mirror while backing. This is the most dangerous and most difficult backing choice. Use the same steps as clear side backing. The only difference is that it is harder to see what you are doing. As you back into the hole, get out a few times to check on things. This is much easier than filling out accident reports and repairing damaged trailers and rammed objects.

8.5. Tight Spaces

8.5.1. Silverpoint has a **"One Meter Rule"** When any piece of equipment is going to be driven within one meter of any stationary object a spotter is required. By stopping and evaluating the route and checking for hazards, downtime and unnecessary costs associated with these incidents can be eliminated.

8.6. The following rules must be followed on all worksites

8.6.1. Keep as much distance as possible between equipment and objects. If the task or scope of work changes, stop and re-evaluate the route. Realignment is a simple task that can be completed quickly to reduce the risks

8.6.2. If realignment or a different route is not possible, and the distance will be close to or within one meter a **Spotter is Mandatory**. (Refer to SOP 2.01-01 ENFORM IRP 12 item # 12.2.2)



8.6.3. Walk around the vehicle and the work area before proceeding . Objects can be hidden beneath the surface and covered in mud , snow , weeds , etc.

Remember : if you are in doubt about what to do, call your Supervisor